



Nintendo's GameBoy ushered in the era of handheld video games

At this time, Nintendo also kick-started the handheld gaming console market with its Game Boy. The console was virtually unchallenged, although Sega's Game Gear and Atari's Lynx tried to compete for a very, very short while.

The shift to high-quality graphics finally happened in 1994-95, when Sony released the PlayStation and Nintendo came out with the Nintendo 64. Sega, a strong competitor up until this point, launched the Saturn and was quickly destroyed by an increasingly unforgiving market.

The 32-bit PlayStation and the 64-bit Nintendo 64 (N64) sparked a visual war, with 3D graphics finally coming to the forefront of games.

This also led to a different kind of battle between the PlayStation and N64, with the two consoles' formats of choice leading to Sony getting the better end of the deal.

The Nintendo 64 used cartridges instead of CDs, thus resisting piracy but at the cost of speed and storage. The PlayStation's decision to use CDs eventually proved to be the factor that led many game developers – such as SquareSoft, the makers of the *Final Fantasy* series – to switch to the PlayStation as the console of choice.



Along with 32-bit gaming, Sony PlayStation and Nintendo 64 finally brought 3D gaming to homes across the world

This round went to the PlayStation and Sony was suddenly at the top of the video game console war with its first foray into the market.

At the same time, in the handheld console world, Nintendo upped the ante with the 'GameBoy Color', which beat its entire opposition into submission. Sega had banked on its *Nomad* finally doing well, but the GameBoy Color almost made the